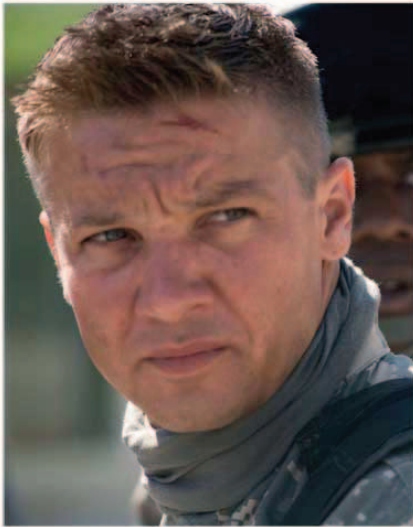




IN CONTEXT

GENRE

War movie

DIRECTOR

Kathryn Bigelow

WRITER

Mark Boal

STARS

Jeremy Renner, Anthony Mackie, Brian Geraghty

BEFORE

1986 Oliver Stone's *Platoon* shows a ground-level view of the Vietnam War.

2001 *Black Hawk Down* emphasizes the comradeship of soldiers even as it seems to criticize American policy.

AFTER

2010 Paul Greengrass's Iraq war movie *Green Zone* uses a handheld camera technique and has a political message.

2012 Kathryn Bigelow makes her adrenaline-fueled movie *Zero Dark Thirty* about the hunt for Osama Bin Laden.

THIS BOX IS FULL OF STUFF THAT ALMOST KILLED ME

THE HURT LOCKER / 2008

Scripted by reporter Mark Boal, Kathryn Bigelow's *The Hurt Locker* follows the story of a three-man US bomb disposal team during the Iraq War. It was shot on location in Syria, near the Iraqi border. Four handheld cameras were used to give a powerfully plausible newsreel effect, out of 200 hours

of footage that was edited down to just 131 minutes. The movie was praised for portraying a viscerally intense, real war experience, although detractors criticized its lack of a moral stance. Bigelow offers little or no comment on the purpose of the war; instead she focuses narrowly and

Staff Sergeant William James runs from the scene of a controlled explosion. He will recklessly return to pick up his gloves.

